Real Estate Legal Guide

General document and transaction checklist for property buyers

Important Note

This is an educational checklist, not legal advice. Property laws, taxes, registration procedures, and required documents vary by country, city, and property type. Verify current requirements with the relevant authority and a qualified professional.

1. Confirm Seller and Ownership

Verify the seller's identity and confirm that the seller has the legal right to transfer the property. If there are multiple owners, confirm that all required parties can participate.

2. Check Property Records

Review available ownership records and identify mortgages, liens, disputes, unpaid charges, restrictions, or other claims that could affect the transaction. Do not rely only on an advertisement or verbal statement.

3. Review the Sale Agreement

The written agreement should clearly describe the parties, property, purchase price, payment schedule, deadlines, included items, conditions, and responsibilities. Read every clause before signing.

4. Verify Approvals and Permits

Depending on the property, check building approvals, development permissions, occupancy or completion documents, and other required authorizations. For apartments or developments, verify project approvals where applicable.

5. Understand Taxes and Fees

Transactions may involve taxes, registration fees, transfer charges, stamp duties, service charges, or other costs. Amounts and responsibilities depend on local rules, so confirm current requirements before purchase.

6. Complete Official Transfer

Follow the required registration and transfer process with the relevant authority. Keep signed agreements, payment records, receipts, and official registration documents.

7. Keep Important Records

Keep identification information, ownership or title records, sale agreement, payment receipts, bank records, tax and fee receipts, registration records, approvals, permits, and inspection reports.

8. Watch for Red Flags

Be careful with pressure to pay immediately, missing ownership documents, refusal to allow reasonable checks, unusually low prices with unclear explanations, undocumented cash requests, and disputes or approvals that cannot be verified.

Final Legal Checklist

Seller identity verified; ownership verified; property records checked; agreement reviewed; approvals checked; taxes and fees understood; official transfer process confirmed; copies of important records saved.